TAGLIATELLE WITH OSSOBUCO AND SOFFRITTO

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4-6	**5 h plus the salting and the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

910 g	Veal shanks, center cut, in 2-inch-thick pieces
14 g	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper
400 g	Fennel bulb
150 g	Carrot
370 g	Onion
103 g	Olive oil
20 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
360 g	Dry white wine
794 g	Whole San Marzano tomatoes, crushed by hand
6 g	Fennel seed
4 g	Dried red chile flakes
5 sprigs	Rosemary
2 sprigs	Thyme
1 batch	Egg dough
quantity not given	Fennel pollen
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated

METHOD

1. Season the shanks with the 14 g salt and leave them 1 to 2 hours, or refrigerate overnight if you have the time. Pepper them just before they go into the pot.
2. Core the fennel and strip off the fronds and stems. Peel the carrot. Cut the fennel, carrot and onion into 1/2- to 1-inch pieces.
3. Run the fennel, onion and carrot through a meat grinder fitted with the small die. Gather the ground vegetables in cheesecloth and wring the liquid out of them. That is your soffritto.
4. Put the olive oil into a large heavy sauce pot or Dutch oven and set it over medium heat. Sear the shanks, turning as needed, until golden brown on every side, 7 to 9 minutes. Lift them onto a plate and scrape any burnt residue out of the pot.
5. Turn the heat to low, add the soffritto and cook gently, stirring often, 5 to 8 minutes, until it has softened but taken no color. Add the garlic right at the end and give it 10 to 15 seconds, just long enough to go aromatic.
6. Return the shanks and pour in the wine. Simmer 5 to 8 minutes, until almost all of it has gone.
7. Add the tomatoes with their juice, then enough water to sit an inch above the shanks. Tie the fennel seed, chile flakes, rosemary and thyme into a cheesecloth sachet and drop it in.
8. Bring it to a simmer over low heat, cover the pot and cook 2 to 3 hours, either on the stove top or in a 275°F oven. The meat is done when it slips off the bone but has not gone to mush. Let it cool in the braising liquid.
9. Fish out the sachet and discard it. Lift the meat from the sauce, pull it off the bones and throw away any sinew or tough membrane. Dig the marrow out of the bones and keep it to spread on bread.
10. Shred the meat into strands with two forks, then run a knife through them to cut 1/4- to 1/2-inch pieces.
11. Skim the fat off the braising liquid and stir the meat back in. Season with salt. Weigh out 450 g of ragu for the pasta. The rest keeps 5 days refrigerated or a month frozen.
12. Cut 624 g of tagliatelle from the egg dough.
13. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil.
14. Set a large saute pan over medium-low heat and add the 450 g ragu.
15. Cook the tagliatelle 30 seconds to 1 minute. It wants to be tender, not soft.
16. Move the pasta across with tongs or a pasta basket and toss about a minute to marry. A splash of pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens. The ragu should coat the strands without clumping them.
17. Divide into bowls and finish with fennel pollen, pepper and the parmigiano.

NOTES

Marrow and the gelatin off the bones give this braise enough richness to carry the pasta on its own. A leaner braise needs a little butter at the end to emulsify.
Wringing the ground vegetables out in cheesecloth takes the water with it, so the soffritto softens rather than steams.
The braise yields far more than the dish uses. 450 g of ragu dresses 624 g of tagliatelle.
Salt the shanks 1 to 2 hours ahead at the very least, overnight if you can plan it.
The whole 103 g of oil goes into the pot at the sear.

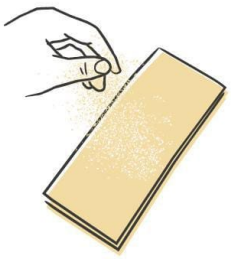
SHAPE
Tagliatelle

Region: Emilia-Romagna and neighboring regions. Called fettuccine in Lazio / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

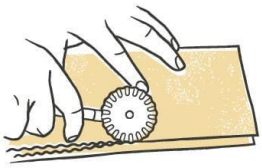
METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 12-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup.
4. Dust each sheet lightly with 00 flour and stack them neatly two or three high. Run a fluted pastry cutter around every edge of the stack so all the edges come out ruffled.
5. Starting at the long edge of the stack, cut 1/2-inch strands working inward. A ruler or straightedge keeps the lines even while you get used to the fluted cutter.
6. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour and shake them apart. Bend the batch into a horseshoe and set it on the pan.
7. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

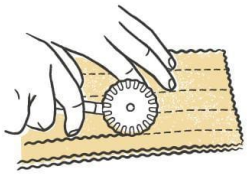
SHAPING



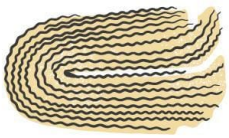
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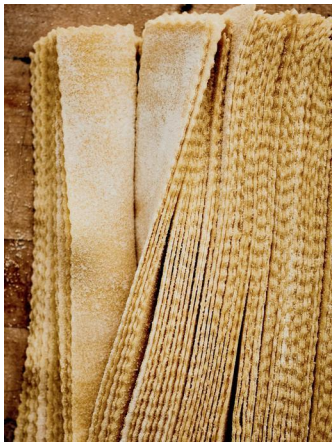
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6

NOTES

Cut width is 1/2 inch, with a fluted pastry cutter.
Bologna's Accademia Italiana della Cucina specifies 1/3 inch. Robbins goes wider on purpose, because her tagliatelle and her fettuccine are rolled to the same thinness and the width is what separates them. Widths vary across the region anyway.
The fluted cutter is Robbins' own distinction for this shape, not a traditional requirement.
Sheets are 12 inches long, stacked two or three high to cut.
Shaped into a horseshoe rather than a nest.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
Suits a hearty ragu, or light butter-and-cheese sauces carrying seasonal vegetables such as mushrooms or zucchini.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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